THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem's phrase 'epistemology of loss' suggests that: 1

(a) loss is rare **(b)** loss is a rule
(c) loss is a game **(d)** loss is a way of gaining knowledge

2. The poem challenges the idea that: 1

(a) children can grieve **(b)** water is deep
(c) loss is real **(d)** everything lost can be replaced

3. Choose the correct conditional: 'If the boy ___ the ball, he would not be at the water.' 1

(a) had not lost **(b)** would not lose **(c)** did not lose **(d)** has not lost

4. The poet's stance towards the boy is best described as: 1

(a) respectful and sympathetic **(b)** careless
(c) silly **(d)** aggressive

5. The poet's detachment is best described as: 1

(a) anger **(b)** amusement
(c) coldness **(d)** empathetic restraint

6. The last lines can be read as: 1

(a) an order **(b)** a joke
(c) a call to buy toys **(d)** a call to resilience

7. In 'The boy who lost the ball stood still', the clause 'who lost the ball' is: 1

(a) a relative clause **(b)** an adverb clause
(c) a noun clause **(d)** a main clause

8. The rhetorical structure of the poem moves from: 1

(a) description to joke **(b)** dialogue to monologue
(c) plot to twist **(d)** question to reflection to counsel

9. A philosophical reading would link the poem with: 1

(a) nihilism **(b)** consumerism **(c)** stoic acceptance **(d)** hedonism

10. A synonym of 'stoic' is: 1

(a) joyful **(b)** patient and uncomplaining
(c) careless **(d)** noisy

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does 'merrily' function ironically in the poem? 2

12. Explain 'learning to stand up' as a metaphor. 2

13. How does syntax mirror the boy's helplessness? 2

14. Why does the poet resist the easy comfort of replacing the ball? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically examine the poem's treatment of consolation. 3

16. Compare the roles of the ball and the harbour as symbols. 3

17. Write a precise paraphrase of: 'He senses first responsibility in a world of possessions'. 3

OR

Analyse the use of paradox in the idea that loss is a form of learning. 3

18. What does the poem imply about the limits of language in grief? 3

OR

Use 'whereas', 'in spite of' and 'as soon as' in sentences about the poem. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The Ball Poem' turns a child's small loss into a lesson in being human. Discuss. 5

OR

Imagine the poem as a scene in a film. Write the script outline. 5

20. Write a critical appreciation of the poem focusing on theme, symbol and tone. 5

OR

Analyse the role of questions in the poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND